



0xDolphin

The Next BIG Thing in Security.

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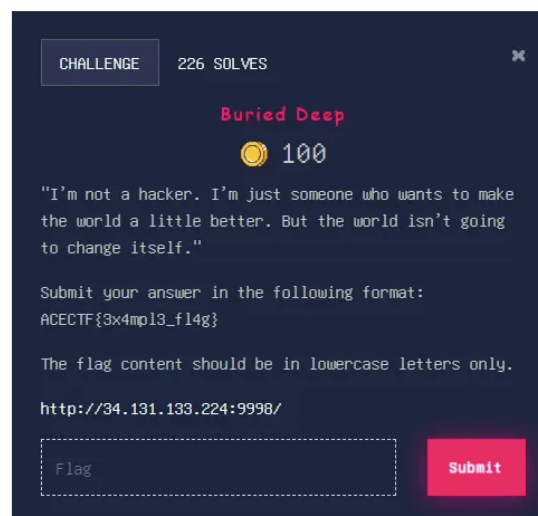
AceCTF — Buried Deep



0xDolphin · 3 min read · Feb 28, 2025



Hello guys, this is Mousa AKA 0xDolphin. Now we will solve the Web Exploitation challenge of Buried Deep in AceCTF together. This is my first ever web challenge to be solved, and I learned new things while I was solving. Shoutout for my friend MM8 for being cool and helpful.



Buried Deep.

First, when we analyze challenge carefully, we come into conclusion that we are searching for hidden directories, which of course has the flag somewhere in its contents. Therefore I was targeting to find robots.txt or something like htaccess? lets try.

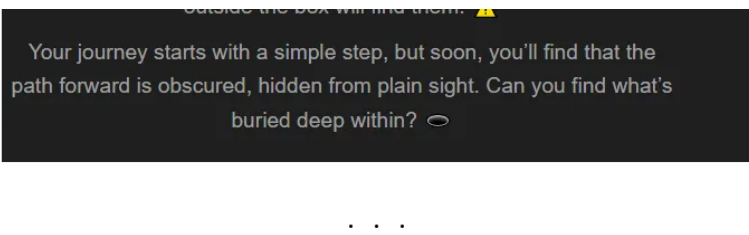
Buried Deep 🕵️

"I'm not a hacker. I'm just someone who wants to make the world a little better. But the world isn't going to change itself." 🤖

Welcome, explorer. You've come seeking the truth, but what you seek is hidden beneath layers of secrets, cryptic paths, and intricate puzzles. 🧐

What you'll find here isn't just a simple challenge. There are things buried deep beneath the surface. Each layer is more difficult to uncover than the last. Some clues are visible, while others are shrouded in mystery, waiting for the keenest of eyes to find them. 🔍

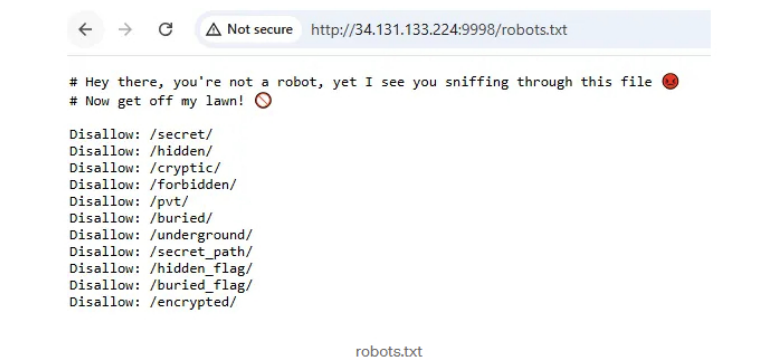
The deeper you dig, the more you uncover. But beware, not everything is as it seems. Some clues are hidden where only those who think outside the box will find them. ⚠️



Actually, we don't need tools like gobuster or anything, it is simpler than that, we just need our brain and Google Chrome.

<http://34.131.133.224:9998/robots.txt>

This is the start of our journey.

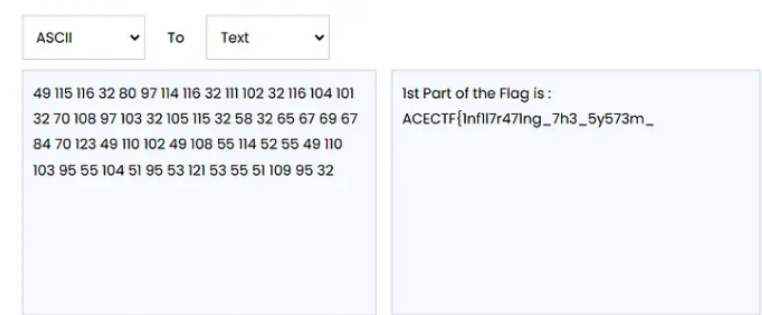


From here, we found hidden directories. By searching carefully in each of them, I found the following:

1. <http://34.131.133.224:9998/buried>



These weird numbers are written in ASCII code, by translating them we get the first part of the flag:



2) http://34.131.133.224:9998/secret_path



wow, Morse Code xD

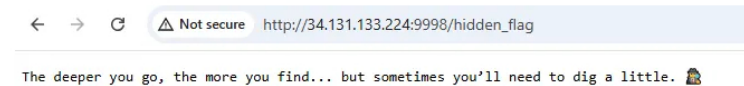
by decoding it we get:

2NDPARTOFTHEFLAGIS:15#345Y#WH3N#YOU#KNOW#WH3R3#

(Take care when we mix the 3 flag parts, it should be all lowercase, return to the main challenge screenshot at the very top).



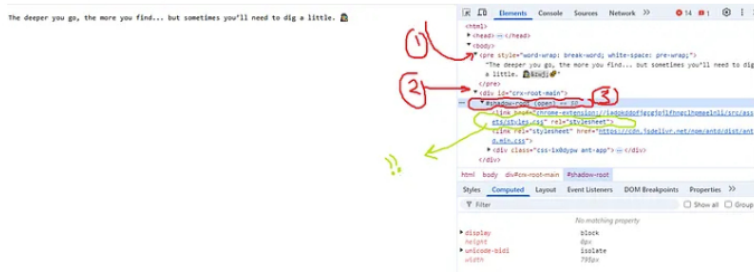
3) http://34.131.133.224:9998/hidden_flag



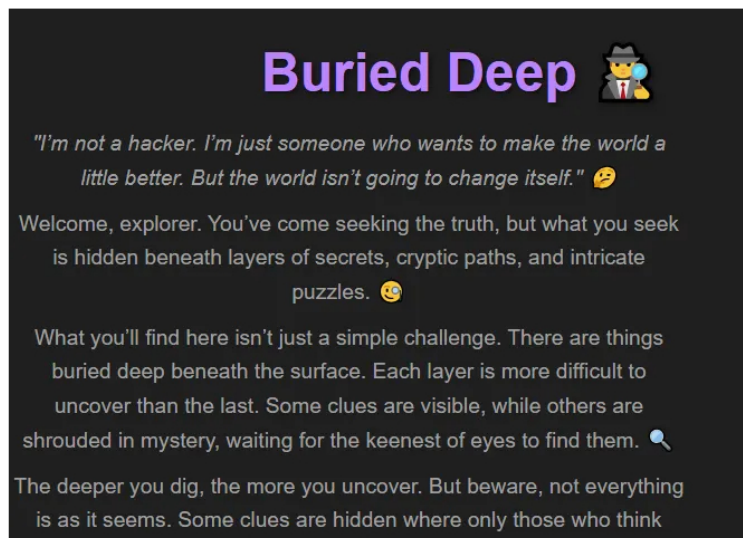
Exciting right?

Let's inspect it together (ctrl+shift+i)

We need to find something hidden, like the following:



Therefore, we deduced that the key is in the CSS (Style Sheets) in the main page.



outside the box will find them. ⚠️

Your journey starts with a simple step, but soon, you'll find that the path forward is obscured, hidden from plain sight. Can you find what's buried deep within? 🕒

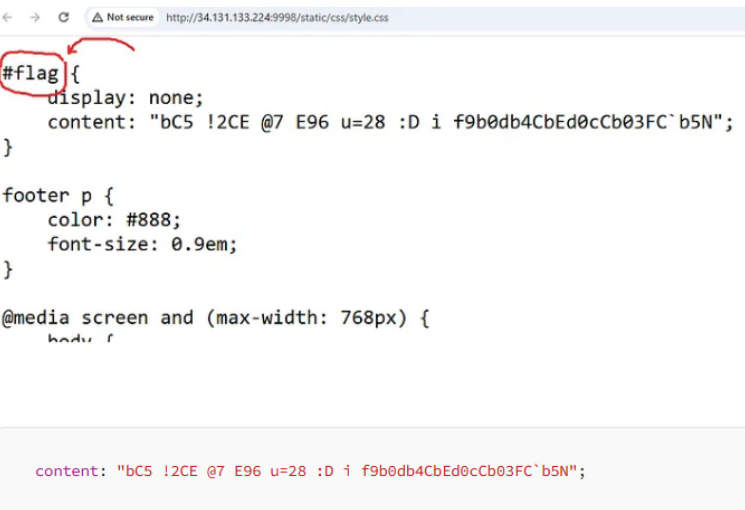
Click Ctrl + U to view source:



Focus on this line, click it:

<link rel="stylesheet" href="/static/css/style.css">

We are now in the style.css, search for #flag.



What is this? This is our Flag but encoded in ROT 47.

ROT13 (A-Z) "oP5 !2PR @7 R96 h=28 :Q :v s9o4qo4PoRqQpPo03SP"o5A"

ROT18 (A-Z, 0-9) "oP0 !7PR @2 R41 h=73 :Q :v s4o5qo9PoRq5pPo58SP"o0A"

ROT47 (!~) Q3rd Part of the Flag is : 7h3_53cr3t5_4r3_bur13dJQ

and Voila. Mix the 3 parts and u get one handsome flag :D



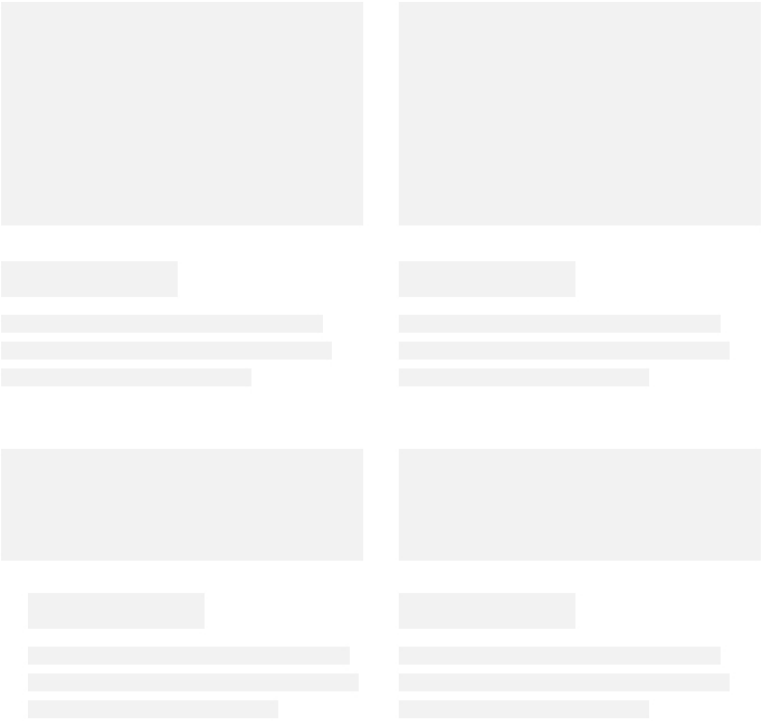


Written by OxDolphin

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